UNIVERSITY OF Baguio
SCHOOL OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT (GDD)

Fowl Play

VERSION NO. 3

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I. GAME OVERVIEW

1.1 High Concept Statement

In *Fowl Play*, one friend signs what he thinks is a free wings-for-life deal at a chicken-themed casino — but the contract's fine print binds anyone who eats the wings too, so sharing them with his three friends drags them all in without any of them signing a thing. Now bound to The House's endless "loyalty" contract, the four of them must gamble their way to enough winnings to void the cursed contract before The House claims them for good.

1.2 Elevator Pitch

Fowl Play is a first-person party game for four players who share one bank account and one very bad contract. One of you signed what looked like a free wings-for-life deal at a chicken-themed casino called The House — except the fine print means anyone who *eats* the wings is bound to the contract too, so sharing them with your friends dragged all four of you in without the rest of you ever signing anything. Now you've got a handful of in-game days to gamble your way to enough winnings to void the contract before it claims you for good. The catch: every bet comes out of the same shared wallet, so when a friend starts pushing their luck too far, you can grab them, punch them into a stunned heap, or drag them bodily away from the table — at your own risk, since hitting a friend costs the entire team too. It's built for small groups who want a short, loud, chaotic multiplayer session full of betrayal, bad decisions, and yelling at your friends to stop gambling.

1.3 Genre, Platform, and Target Audience

Genre and sub-genre	First-person co-op party game / "chaos casino" sub-genre — social sabotage mechanics layered over casino minigames.
Genre conventions the game keeps	Short, replayable sessions; simple, immediately-readable controls; humor-forward tone; designed to be funnier with more people watching/reacting.
Genre conventions the game breaks	Most party-chaos games (Overcooked, Fall Guys, GWYF itself) use top-down or third-person cameras specifically because they're easier to keep readable with physical chaos — *Fowl Play* uses first-person instead, betting that per-player screens and grounded, at-the-table minigames create more tension than the usual wide, cartoonish view. It also breaks from typical party games by giving its minigames real decision depth, with press-your-luck calls in Chicken Cross (built in the submitted prototype) and in blackjack, roulette, poker, and Eggsweeper (designed, not yet built), instead of simplified abstracted mechanics.

Target platform	PC (Windows), keyboard and mouse. The full-game target is LAN-based local multiplayer for four players. The submitted prototype is single-player.
Target audience	Small friend groups, late teens to mid-20s, comfortable with basic first-person movement controls, looking for a short, social, chaotic party session rather than a long-form single-player experience.
Expected session length	One full run (survive 10 days) is roughly 40–55 minutes, designed to be replayed multiple times in one sitting with the same group.

1.4 Scope and Feasibility Statement

In scope for this term	A single-player prototype of the Fowl Play core loop, with the four-player LAN design kept in this document as the full-game target. First-person player camera; one chicken-themed casino room with an exit door and an exit zone; one table, Chicken Cross (12 lanes, press-your-luck cash out or push); a shared wallet with live HUD feedback; the full 10-day structure with a 5-minute timer per day, a rising daily quota, and a max bet of half the quota; 1 extra life (when quota is missed, the wallet is reset to half of its day-start balance); hit and stun on two stationary teammate dummies, with every hit costing 0.5% of the day's quota; an early day end at the exit zone once quota is met; main menu, pause, win, and game over screens; the contract line, exit door state change, and lighting shift as narrative flavor; procedurally generated placeholder audio.

Out of scope (deliberately cut)	Cut from this build: LAN multiplayer and host-authoritative sync (the prototype is single-player, so the exit-zone rule is met by the one player); blackjack, roulette, the poker-flavored game, and Eggsweeper (designed in Section 6.4 but not built); the daily minigame rotation (only one table exists); the Watched Blessed/Cursed system; carry, drop, and throw (stun is built, carrying is not); the integrated safe corner. Cut from the whole project: internet-facing online multiplayer; proximity voice chat; full Texas Hold'em-style poker with real hand-ranking and betting rounds; multiple rooms or floors; true joint-based ragdoll physics; the 6-item stretch system; the hidden cumulative-earnings alt-ending; character customization and emotes; detailed or fully animated character models.

Feasibility justification	With a 5-person team and only one confirmed synchronous block (Tuesday lab, 11 AM–2 PM) where all members can physically test LAN multiplayer together, the scope above was built around that constraint specifically: core networking and physics-sync work is front-loaded into early Tuesday sessions, since that is the only reliable window to verify host/join behavior and knockback sync across multiple real devices. Wednesday's half-day in the afternoon and Friday's fully online day support solo or pair work — asset creation, minigame logic, and UI that don't require the whole team in the same room — while Saturday is treated as a flexible group work day for integration and playtesting once individual pieces are ready. This rhythm is why the scope favors *one* system done well over several done partially: a single room, five focused minigames, and a simplified stun/carry mechanic are all achievable inside roughly one lab session a week plus asynchronous solo work. A more ambitious version of this concept — a larger minigame roster, multiple rooms or floors, true physics-based ragdoll simulation, or genuine internet-facing netcode — would each demand far more synchronized team time than this schedule realistically allows, which is why they're logged as out of scope or stretch goals rather than committed features. The submitted build was completed by one team member within the midterm lab period, with no second LAN-capable device available for testing. It is therefore a single-player vertical slice of the core loop (bet, push or cash out, day quota, extra life, win and lose states), with multiplayer and the remaining four tables kept as documented design targets for later work.

II. FORMAL ELEMENTS

Players	4 players, local co-op (not competitive), as the full-game design: everyone works toward the same shared goal, though individual choices (greedy bets, risky pushes) can work against the group even without anyone intending to win against a teammate. In the submitted prototype there is 1 player plus 2 stationary dummy teammates that can be hit and stunned.
Objectives	Win condition: survive all 10 days by meeting each day's quota, without missing quota twice, which voids the contract. Immediate objective each day: have a wallet at or above that day's quota when the day ends. The day ends when the 5:00 timer runs out, or earlier when quota is already met and every connected player stands in the exit zone.
Rules	The wallet is shared: all winnings and losses apply to one pool, not individual accounts. Only one player may occupy a table at a time. A seated player cannot move or hit. Leaving the table mid-round forfeits the bet. The max bet is half of the day's quota, rounded down to the nearest 10 and never more than the wallet. At Chicken Cross, each push crosses one of 12 lanes with a rising bust chance; a bust loses the bet, and cashing out pays the bet times the current lane's multiplier (Section 6.4). Any player may hit any other player at any time, with no cooldown or restriction, but every hit costs 0.5% of the day's quota, which leaves the wallet for good. A hit stuns the target into a scripted limp pose (not a simulated ragdoll) for a short time (provisional: 5 seconds). The exit zone ends the day early only when quota is already met and all connected players are standing inside it.
Procedures	Each day, in order: (1) The House announces the day's quota on screen (and, on Day 1, reads the contract line); (2) Players move freely around the room and choose whether to approach the table; (3) At the table, a player sits down, raises or lowers the bet, places it, and then, for each lane, chooses to push for the next lane or cash out; (4) At any point, other players may hit a teammate, which stuns them and costs the wallet 0.5% of the quota; (5) The day ends the moment either condition is met: the timer reaches 0:00, or quota is met and all connected players are in the exit zone before time runs out; (6) At day end, the wallet is compared to the quota. If it is met, the next day begins. If it is not, the extra-life penalty applies (see Outcome).

Resources	The shared wallet (starts at 1,000 from The House's one-time Day 1 loan; spent on bets, earned from cash-outs, drained by hits, and reset to half of its day-start balance when quota is first missed); the extra life, a one-time pass that lets the run continue past a single failed day and is spent the first time quota is missed; time (the 5:00 daily countdown); and a teammate's stunned state, which removes that player from play for a short time.
Conflict	The escalating daily quota under time pressure; the tension between an individual player's temptation to push one more lane and the group's collective risk; the max bet, which grows with the quota so one bust can end a day late in the run; and the fact that stopping a friend costs the entire team something too, so there is no purely safe way to intervene.
Boundaries	Physically, the game is confined to a single casino room, The House, with one table, an exit door, and an exit zone; there is no other space to go. Conceptually, play is bounded by the day structure: only the wallet, the day number, and the extra life carry from one day to the next, and each day is a fresh 5-minute attempt with its own quota.
Outcome	Win (day): quota is met at day end, by timer expiry or by an early exit, and the next day begins at its higher quota. Win (run): quota is met on Day 10, which voids the contract. Penalty: quota is missed and the extra life is unspent. The extra life is spent, the wallet is reset to half of the balance the team started that day with, and whatever was won or lost that day is discarded. The next day's quota is still calculated from the failed day's day-start wallet, so the gap is more than double the normal one. A first miss on Day 10 gives one final attempt at Day 10. Loss: quota is missed and the extra life is already spent. The lights cut, the contract remains, and the run ends regardless of how much money is left in the wallet.

III. MDA AND PLAYER EXPERIENCE

3.1 Mechanics, Dynamics, and Aesthetics

Mechanic (as authored)	Dynamic it is expected to produce	Aesthetic / kind of fun it serves
Single shared wallet across all players	Players self-police each other's bets in real time; anxiety spikes whenever anyone else is gambling, not just yourself	Fellowship (shared stakes) turning into Challenge (managing a resource you don't fully control)
Press-your-luck decision inside each minigame (cash out vs. push)	Escalating suspense at the table, amplified by teammates watching and reacting out loud	Challenge (risk/reward tension) and Fantasy (the thrill of "one more bet")
Watched Blessed/Cursed status, re-rolled and announced daily	Group strategy shifts day to day around protecting or exploiting whoever's flagged	Discovery (each day plays differently) and Fellowship (coordinated group response)
Free, spammable hit-to-stun (no cooldown), each hit shakes a small amount of money loose from the target's shared wallet	Players hit each other constantly for fun, but self-regulate as a group once the wallet visibly shrinks from overuse — chaos has a shared, not individual, cost	Sensation (spammable slapstick) balanced against Challenge (the group collectively feels the cost)
Carry-lock: a stunned player can only wake when dropped or thrown, not while held	Teammates physically drag a stubborn or tilted gambler toward the exit against their will; genuine tug-of-war if that player fights to get back to a table	Fellowship (forcing the group toward a shared goal) and Sensation (comedic struggle/chase)

Mechanic (as authored)	Dynamic it is expected to produce	Aesthetic / kind of fun it serves
Exit zone: all 4 players must stand together in a marked area to manually end the day	The day's ending becomes a coordination event, not a menu action — someone's always missing, stuck at a table, or being dragged in late	Challenge (last-second coordination) and Fellowship (a shared "we made it" moment)
Failing quota halves the shared wallet and spends the team's one extra life	Players grow visibly more risk-averse and coordinated once the extra life is gone, since the next failure ends the run outright	Challenge (rising stakes-awareness as the safety net disappears)
Randomized daily rotation of which minigames are open	Players adjust strategy day to day rather than falling into a fixed routine; scouting the room becomes a small ritual at the start of each day	Discovery (variety keeps each day feeling distinct)

3.2 Targeted Kinds of Fun

Fowl Play primarily targets **Fellowship** and **Challenge.** Fellowship comes from the shared wallet and the physical sabotage mechanics — nearly everything a player does is legible to and affects their friends, and the best moments (a desperate tackle, a shared "no, don't push it" groan) only exist because other people are in the room. Challenge comes from the press-your-luck decisions inside each minigame and the daily quota under time pressure, which stay meaningful because failure has a real, visible cost to the whole group, not just the individual gambling.

A secondary target is **Sensation** — the physical comedy of the hit/stun/carry mechanic is a deliberate source of fun independent of the gambling systems, giving the game a moment-to-moment kinetic quality rather than being purely a decision-making game.

Deliberately not pursued: **Narrative.** The contract/wings premise exists as comedic flavor and a framing device, not a story the player is meant to follow closely or feel emotionally invested in beyond the opening joke. Given the term's scope and a 5-person team's available hours, depth was intentionally spent on the social/physical systems

(Fellowship, Challenge, Sensation) rather than on branching story content, dialogue, or character writing — a trade-off that fits a short, replayable party format better than a narrative-driven one would.

3.3 Player Types and Motivation

Fowl Play is designed primarily around **Bartle's Socializer** type, with a deliberate secondary appeal to **Killer**-type impulses inside a cooperative frame. Socializers are served directly by the shared wallet (every decision is inherently social) and by the Watched system (which gives the group something new to talk about and react to every day). The hit mechanic, meanwhile, offers a controlled outlet for Killer-style impulses — knocking a friend around is unrestricted and spammable, which serves pure physical-comedy appeal — without the game becoming genuinely competitive, since every hit drains the *shared* wallet rather than costing the hitter personally. This keeps the Killer-adjacent action self-limiting at the group level: the fun of spamming hits is real, but a team that overdoes it visibly erodes its own shared resource, which naturally pulls the behavior back toward Fellowship-driven cooperation rather than needing an individual penalty to enforce restraint.

3.4 Player Experience (PX) Goals

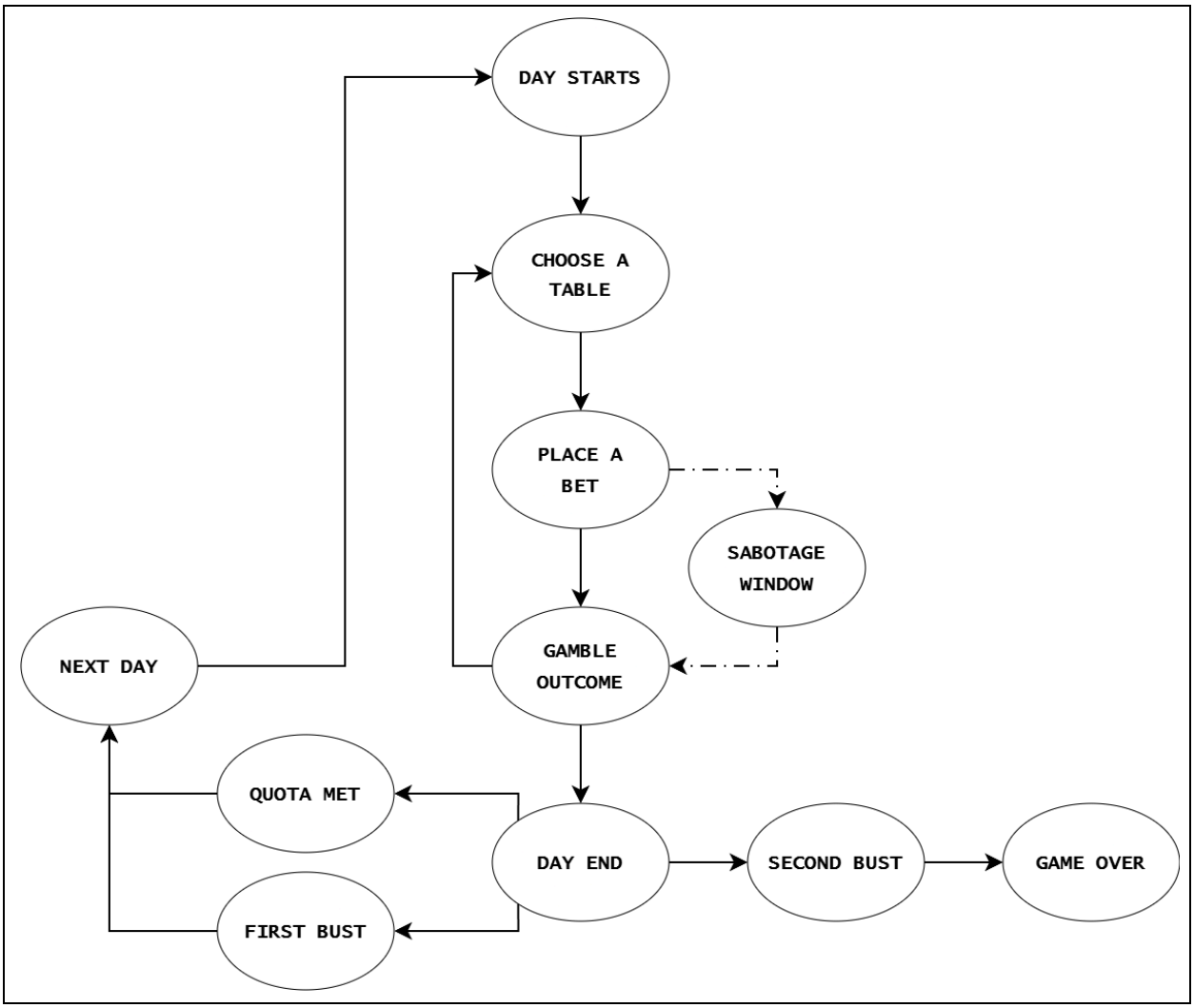
PX goal (what the player should feel, and when)	Design feature intended to produce it	How you would observe it in a playtest
A jolt of panic when a teammate's bet is climbing dangerously high	Real-time wallet feedback (shake/flash) plus an escalating audio cue tied to bet size	Players lean toward the screen, reach for movement input, or verbally call out ("stop, stop, STOP") without being prompted

PX goal (what the player should feel, and when)	Design feature intended to produce it	How you would observe it in a playtest
Mischievous triumph after successfully tackling a friend away from a table just in time	The hit/stun mechanic's impact feedback (knockback force, sound, brief slow-down) paired with the carry-to-safety follow-up	Laughter or cheering in the moment; players asking to replay that day or bragging about the tackle afterward
Relief and satisfaction when the whole team finally makes it into the exit zone together after a chaotic day	The exit zone requires all 4 players physically present at once — a visible, shared "we made it" moment rather than a menu confirmation	Players physically rush/sprint toward the zone together near time's end; audible celebration or a shared exhale when the day closes
A sinking "oh no, here we go again" feeling the moment quota isn't met and the extra-life penalty kicks in	A distinct visual/audio cue from The House when the extra life is triggered, paired with a visibly harsher tone (lighting shift, quota increase) for the final life	Players go quiet or visibly tense up when the penalty triggers; more cautious, coordinated play afterward compared to earlier in the day
A rush of temptation at the exact moment a minigame offers "cash out or push further"	The press-your-luck prompt itself — framed to visually emphasize what's already been won vs. what's still on the table	Players hesitate, verbally think out loud ("should I—"), or get audibly egged on / warned by teammates watching nearby

PX goal (what the player should feel, and when)	Design feature intended to produce it	How you would observe it in a playtest
Curiosity and light anticipation at the start of each day, wondering which games rotated in	The randomized daily minigame pool, revealed at day-start alongside the quota	Players actively scan/comment on which tables are open before deciding where to go, rather than heading straight to a fixed table out of habit
Comic indignation or mock-betrayal at being knocked down and dragged away by a teammate mid-bet	The hit-to-stun and carry-lock mechanics, paired with the carried player retaining look/camera control so they can visibly react	Player laughs, protests out loud, or exaggeratedly struggles/complains while being carried, rather than staying silent
A deflating, almost funny sense of doom when quota isn't met a second time, with no extra life left, and the run actually ends	A distinct "final loss" sting from The House — heavier and more final than the extra-life penalty cue — paired with a visual shift in the room (lights fully cutting, machines going dark, The House's "voice" delivering a closing line)	Players react audibly (groaning, laughing at the absurdity, blaming each other) rather than going silent; players immediately ask to restart rather than feeling like the session is truly "over"

IV. CORE GAMEPLAY LOOP

4.1 Core Loop Diagram



4.2 Loop Walkthrough

A single pass through the loop starts the moment a new day opens: The House announces the quota, reveals which of the five minigames are active that day, and names who's Watched — Blessed and Cursed. From there, players scatter to the tables that look worth the risk. One player sits down and places a bet; the game offers a choice to cash out or push for more, and as the bet climbs, the wallet visibly reacts, pulling the other three players' attention whether they want it or not. If someone decides the bet has gone too far, they can rush over and hit the gambler — a free, spammable action that shakes a small amount of money out of the shared wallet — stunning them, then pick them up and carry them away; once carried, the stunned player can't act again until they're dropped or thrown. This sabotage loop can happen to anyone, at any table, at any moment, and often overlaps with two or three other bets happening at once elsewhere in the room. This continues — bet, react, maybe sabotage, repeat — until either the quota is hit and the timer runs out naturally, the team chooses to gather early at the exit zone once quota's already met, or the timer runs out with quota unmet, triggering the extra-life penalty

for one harder, tenser final attempt. One full pass, start to day-end, is expected to take close to the full 5-minute timer on most days, since the loop is designed to be re-entered many times within a single day rather than resolved in one bet.

4.3 Macro and Micro Loops

Micro loop	Choose a Table → Place a Bet → Gamble Outcome → back to Choose a Table. This repeats continuously within a single day, and can be interrupted at any point by the Sabotage Window — any player can hit another mid-bet, stunning and potentially carrying them off, without ending the loop itself.
Macro loop	Day Starts → the micro loop repeats until Day End → branches to Quota Met, First Bust, or Second Bust → Quota Met and First Bust both route into Next Day, which loops back to Day Starts for a fresh, harder day. Second Bust is the one path that breaks the macro loop entirely, ending the run at Game Over.
Relationship between them	Every outcome inside the micro loop (a win, a loss, a successful sabotage) feeds the same shared wallet the macro loop is tracking — there's no separate currency or unlock system bridging the two. The macro loop doesn't change what the micro loop *is*; it only raises what the micro loop has to survive, since each new day tightens the quota and re-rolls who's Watched. So the moment-to-moment gameplay a player is doing on Day 4 is mechanically identical to Day 1 — what's different is how much margin for error they have left.

4.4 In-Game and Out-Game Actions

In-game actions	Moving through the casino room; sitting at a table and placing a bet; making the cash-out-or-push decision inside a minigame; hitting a teammate to stun them; picking up, carrying, and dropping/throwing a stunned teammate; gathering together at the exit zone to end a day early once quota is met; reacting to The House's day-start announcements (quota, minigame rotation, Watched status) and day-end outcome (success, penalty, or Game Over).

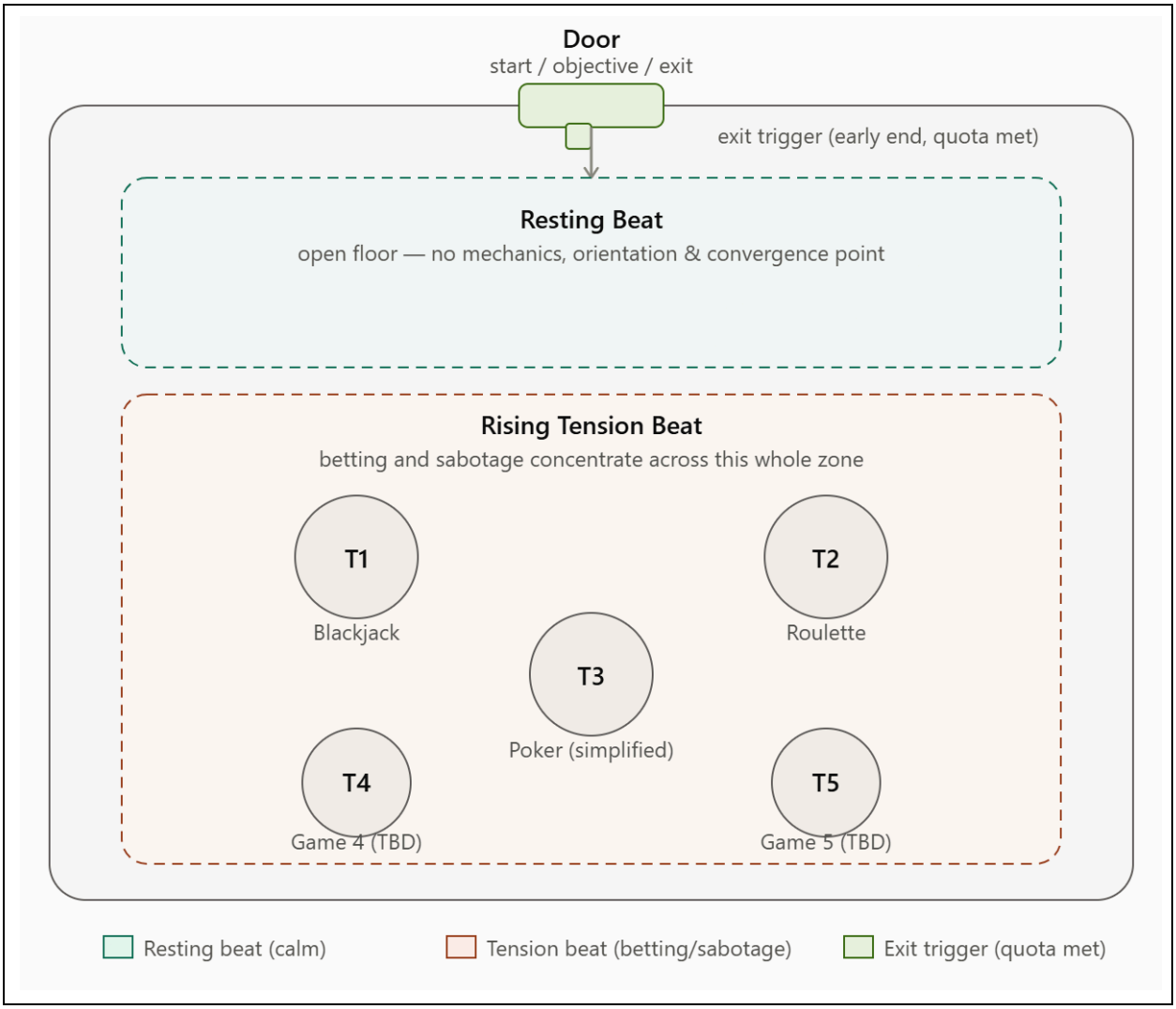
Out-game actions	Hosting or joining a LAN session before a run begins, via the lobby/connect screen. Beyond that, there are no menus, upgrades, or shop screens between days — this is a deliberate design choice, not an omission: every system that would normally live in an out-game menu (wallet total, extra-life status, Watched rotation, rising quota) instead persists and escalates automatically inside the run itself, so the tension of the macro loop is never interrupted by stepping outside the fiction into a UI screen .

V. LEVEL DESIGN

5.1 Level Layout Pattern

Fowl Play's casino floor uses an **open layout** — a single room with no interior walls, corridors, or sightline-blocking geometry, all five tables and the exit door visible and reachable from anywhere in the space. This is a direct consequence of the core gameplay loop: players need to notice a teammate's bet escalating from across the room (the shared-wallet panic response is the core tension driver), and the daily minigame rotation needs to be scoutable at a glance the moment a day starts. A linear or hub-and-spoke layout would force players through fixed paths or sightline-limited spokes, which would mute both of those — an open floor lets risk be read purely through distance and visibility rather than through forced structure, which fits a game whose central mechanic is social awareness of what your friends are doing right now.

5.2 Annotated Level Map



5.3 Pacing and Difficulty Curve

Within a single day, difficulty isn't driven by where a player is standing — it's driven by the relationship between the 5-minute timer and quota progress. Early in a day, with time to spare, any bet feels low-stakes; the same bet with the timer nearly out and quota still unmet becomes the day's most tense moment, regardless of which table it happens at.

The **flow-channel fit point** sits in the day's middle stretch — enough time has passed that the player has real information (how close is quota, is anyone Watched, how much is banked) to make a deliberate risk read, without the final-seconds panic overriding judgment. This is where the press-your-luck decision is meant to feel like genuine skill rather than a blind gamble or a trivial non-choice.

The **boredom risk** sits at the very start of a day — a full 5 minutes with no pressure yet can make early bets feel inconsequential. This is mitigated by the Watched (Blessed/Cursed) announcement firing at day-start, giving players an immediate reason to care about that day's specific conditions before time pressure exists.

The **anxiety risk** sits in the final moments of the timer with quota still unmet — the compounding dread of running out of time while a friend might still be mid-bet. This is mitigated by the extra-life system: failing is a real penalty (wallet halved), but not instantly fatal, keeping the peak-tension moment high-stakes without becoming so punishing that players stop pushing their luck altogether.

5.4 Teaching Mechanics Through Level Sequencing

Mechanic to be taught	Where it is introduced	How the level teaches it
Press-your-luck betting (cash out vs. push)	Any table, first bet a player makes — naturally falls early on Day 1, when quota is still easy and the timer isn't a factor yet	Environmental cue: the minigame's own UI visually distinguishes "what you'd bank" from "what you're risking" through scale/color, so the choice is legible without text instructions

Mechanic to be taught	Where it is introduced	How the level teaches it
Hit-to-stun sabotage	Day 1, whenever any player's bet first climbs high enough to visibly shake/flash the shared wallet	Environmental cue + isolated safe space: the wallet's own reaction is what draws attention to the option to intervene, and because Day 1's quota is forgiving, a mistimed or unnecessary hit costs the team almost nothing — safe room to experiment with a mechanic that's riskier on later days
Carry (pick up / drop / throw)	Immediately following a player's first stun, same Day 1 moment	Environmental cue: a stunned player's ragdolled pose and a context prompt when another player walks into them makes the follow-up action discoverable without a tutorial popup
Exit convergence (end the day early)	End of Day 1, once quota is first met	Environmental cue: the door — already seen at spawn — visibly changes state (light, sound, or similar) once quota is hit, drawing players back to a space they already know rather than introducing a new location

VI. SYSTEMS AND BALANCE

6.1 Resource Economy

Resource	Source (how it enters play)	Sink (how it leaves play)	Starting value
Shared wallet	The House's one-time Day 1 loan; winnings cashed out at the five tables	Lost bets (bomb, failed crossing, losing hand or spin); every hit (0.5% of that day's quota, gone for good); halved when quota is first missed	1,000
Extra life	Granted once at the start of the run	Spent on the first missed quota; never regained	1
Time	A full 5:00 timer at the start of every day	Counts down in real time; leftover time is discarded if the day ends early at the exit zone	5:00 per day
Stunned state	Created when a hit lands on a standing player	Ends when the stunned player is dropped or thrown, never while carried	0 players stunned

6.2 Progression Curve

Day	Quota multiplier	Day-start wallet	Quota	Max bet
1	1.25	1,000	1,250	620
2	1.28	1,250	1,600	800
3	1.32	1,600	2,112	1,050
4	1.36	2,112	2,872	1,430
5	1.40	2,872	4,021	2,010
6	1.45	4,021	5,830	2,910
7	1.50	5,830	8,745	4,370
8	1.55	8,745	13,555	6,770
9	1.62	13,555	21,959	10,970
10	1.70	21,959	37,330	18,660

Fowl Play has no upgrades, unlocks, or shops (Section 4.4), so the team does not gain new abilities as the run goes on. Capability and challenge scale through the same two numbers: the quota multiplier and the max bet. All values here are provisional and will be tuned in LAN playtesting.

The run starts from a 1,000-coin wallet. Each day's quota is the day-start wallet multiplied by that day's multiplier, and the multiplier rises from 1.25 on Day 1 to 1.70 on Day 10, so the required gain climbs from +25% to +70% of the wallet the team walked in with. The max bet for any wager is half of that day's quota, rounded down to the nearest 10 and never more than the wallet, so betting power grows in step with the quota. The table shows a team that ends every day exactly at quota; a team that overshoots sees larger absolute numbers at the same relative challenge, because surplus raises the next quota.

Because the micro loop is identical on each every day (Section 4.3), difficulty is the size of the gap, not new mechanics. The tables pay generously at the stops players actually use, so the quota can be high. On Day 1, two or three well-chosen bets close the gap, which keeps the opening forgiving (Section 5.4). By Day 10, a single max bet is about 85% of the wallet and the gap is close to what one good crossing pays, so late days are decided by a few large bets, and one bust can put the day out of reach. A missed quota shows up as a visible spike in the curve: after the penalty, the wallet is halved but the next quota is still calculated from the wallet at the start of the failed day, so the team must gain roughly 150% to 240% of what it holds that day, more than double the normal gap.

6.3 Symmetry, Asymmetry, and Fairness

Fowl Play is a symmetric game with a rotating, temporary asymmetry on top. All four players have identical abilities and rules: the same movement, the same access to every table, and the same hit, stun, carry, and throw. No one has a class, a personal account, or an individual score, and the outcome is shared, so the team wins or loses together and no player can profit at a teammate's expense. Hitting is the clearest example: it is free and unrestricted, but every hit drains the shared wallet, so griefing a friend costs the griefer's own team, and a stunned player keeps camera control (Section 3.4) so they are never reduced to a bystander.

The only asymmetry is the Watched pair. Each day, one random player is Blessed and one is Cursed, each with one of three small effects that change a number (payout, loss, bet cap, or hit cost) and never remove a player's ability to act. The pair is announced at day start, so no advantage is hidden, and it is re-rolled daily with safeguards against the same player being Cursed twice in a row. A second, positional asymmetry is that only one player may occupy a table at a time, which turns who gets to gamble into a negotiation inside the group, not an unfair rule.

The outcome is meant to feel fair because the opposing system plays by rules the team can read. The House's pressure is the quota, shown on screen as wallet over quota. The tables pay above fair at the stops players actually use and below fair only deep in a push, so going too far is a visible choice with a visible price. Quota is calculated from the current wallet, so the challenge stays the same size whether the team is rich or poor. Some outcomes are harsh by design, such as a missed quota halving the wallet and widening the next day's gap, but that harshness applies identically to every team.

6.4 Randomness and Probability

System using randomness	Probability / range of values	Purpose of the randomness	Safeguard against unfair outcomes
Chicken Cross (lane busts)	Bust chance per lane (lanes 1-12): 7, 9, 11, 14, 17, 20, 24, 28, 32, 37, 42, 48%. Chance to reach lane 6: 43%; lane 12: 3%. Multipliers 1.3x to 15x	Makes every step a press-your-luck decision with a visible price for going on	Lanes 1-7 pay above fair (111-144% return) so sensible stops profit; lanes 8-12 pay below fair (46-89%) so greed costs; cash out after any lane; host rolls every step

VII. NARRATIVE DESIGN

7.1 Premise and Setting

Fowl Play takes place entirely inside The House, a chicken-themed casino that exists as a single room and never closes. The player is one of four friends bound to a contract after eating wings from a "free wings-for-life" deal that only one of them signed. The fine print binds anyone who eats the wings, so all four now owe The House, and the contract can only be voided by winning enough money across 10 days. The House lends the group a one-time 1,000 coin loan on Day 1 and then watches. The narrative is deliberately minimal (Section 3.2): the premise explains why four friends gamble from one shared wallet, then gets out of the way of the social and physical systems.

7.2 Narrative Delivery Method

The story never stops the game. There are no cutscenes, dialogue trees, or text logs. It reaches the player through The House's announcer voice and through changes in the room itself, all of which already exist as part of the core loop. Three concrete examples of environmental storytelling:

1. The announcer voice. On Day 1, The House's voice reads the contract's key line as the day opens, then delivers every day-start announcement (quota, open tables, Watched players) in the same voice. The premise is repeated as routine, not as exposition.
2. The room's lighting and machines. When the extra life is spent, the lighting shifts to a harsher tone (Section 3.4). At Game Over, the lights cut, the machines go dark, and The House delivers a closing line. The player reads how close they are to losing from the room, without a menu telling them.
3. The exit door. The door is visible from spawn and changes state (light, sound) once quota is met (Section 5.4). In the fiction, it is the contract's release valve. Leaving is earned, and it only works if all connected players walk through it together.

7.3 Branching and Player Agency

The narrative is linear: Day 1 through Day 10, ending in either a win (quota met on Day 10) or Game Over (second missed quota). A branching story would need extra writing, dialogue, and endings, and Section 1.4 already cuts the hidden alt-ending, so the team spent its hours on the Fellowship, Challenge, and Sensation systems instead (Section 3.2).

Player agency lives in the one decision the game repeats at every table: cash out or push. Cashing out gives up the bigger payout and the faster route to quota. Pushing gives up the bet already on the table and, because the wallet is shared, puts teammates' money at risk too. Each day also forces a second decision, whether to hit a friend or let the bet ride, which gives up either wallet money (every hit drains the shared wallet) or the chance of a bust being stopped.

Linear flow for the diagram:
Day 1 (contract line) → Days 2–9 → Day 10 → Win,
with a missed quota branching to the extra-life penalty and a second miss to Game Over.

VIII. TECHNICAL DESIGN

8.1 2D, 3D, or Hybrid Decision

Fowl Play is a 3D game built around first-person cameras. Readability: the core tension depends on players noticing a teammate's bet from across the room and on being physically able to hit, grab, and carry each other, so a grounded 3D space with real distance and sightlines serves the loop better than a flat view (Sections 1.3 and 5.1). Scope: the game is one open room with low-poly props, five table interactions, and a scripted limp-pose stun instead of ragdoll physics, so the 3D workload stays small (Section 1.4). Team skill: [CONFIRM: describe the team's experience with Godot 4 3D, CharacterBody3D movement, and LAN multiplayer]. To keep the 3D scope matched to that skill level, characters are simple primitives with no detailed animation, and the physics sync is host-authoritative with basic interpolation.

8.2 Camera System

Camera type	First-person Camera3D, one per player, attached to the player's Head node and controlled by mouse look. Each client activates only its own camera. Field of view starts at 75 degrees (provisional, to be tuned in LAN playtesting).
What the camera must always keep visible	What the camera must always keep visible | The HUD overlay with wallet versus quota, the 5:00 timer, the current day, extra-life status, and the Watched banner. When seated, the table's cash-out-or-push state and the bet versus the amount banked. In the room, teammates, the other tables, and the exit door's state.

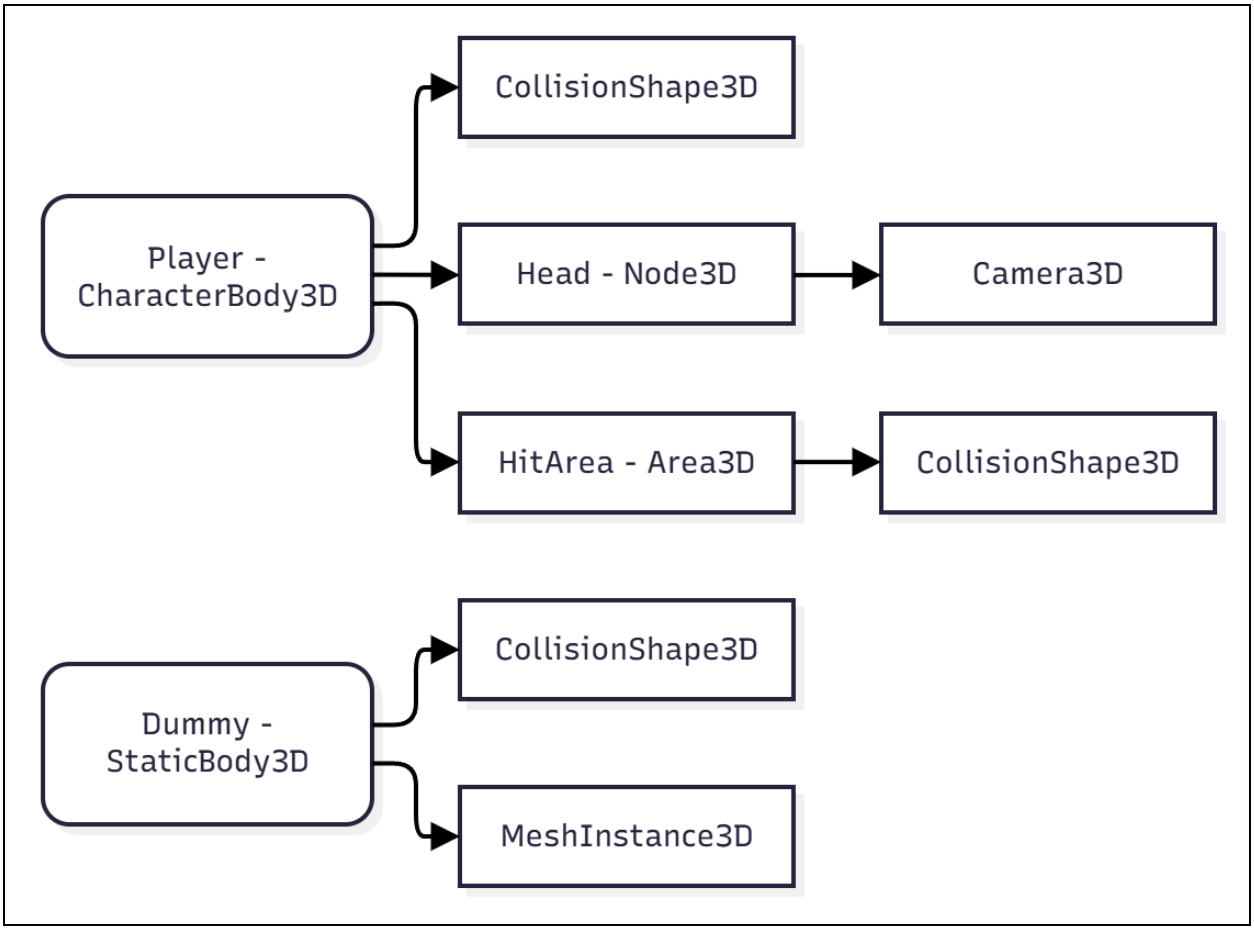
Readability risks	(1) Teammates outside the field of view while a bet escalates: mitigated by the wallet shake/flash, the escalating audio cue tied to bet size, directional 3D audio for hits, and the open layout. (2) Stunned or carried view pointing at the floor or the carrier's back: the carried player keeps look control (Section 3.4), with the camera anchored to the carry point and pitch clamped so they can still see the room and react. (3) Tunnel vision while seated: table UI sits in the lower centre of the screen, the player can still look around, and the wallet HUD stays on screen. (4) Discomfort from knockback or throws: any camera shake is brief, with no roll.

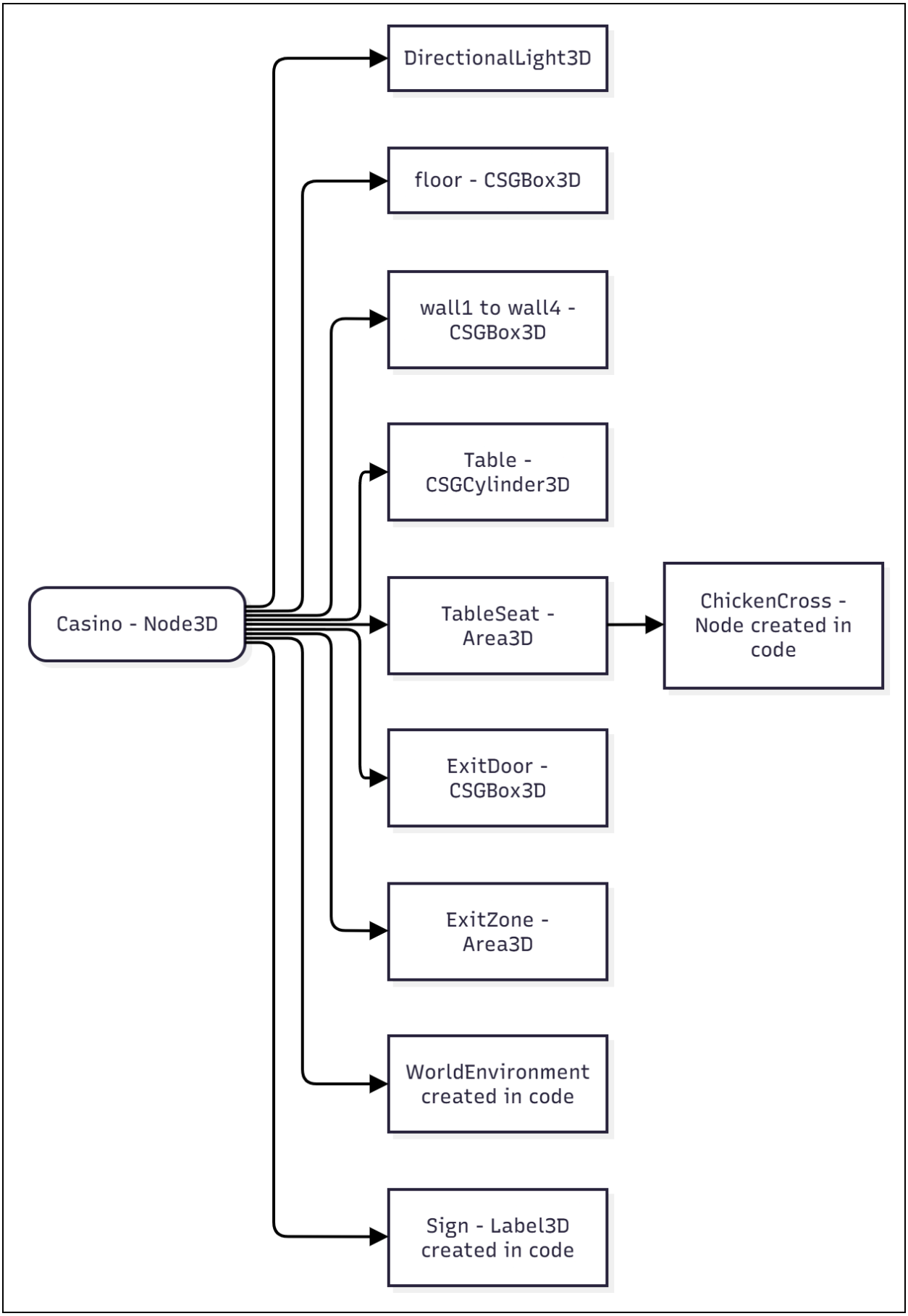
8.3 Control Scheme and Input Mapping

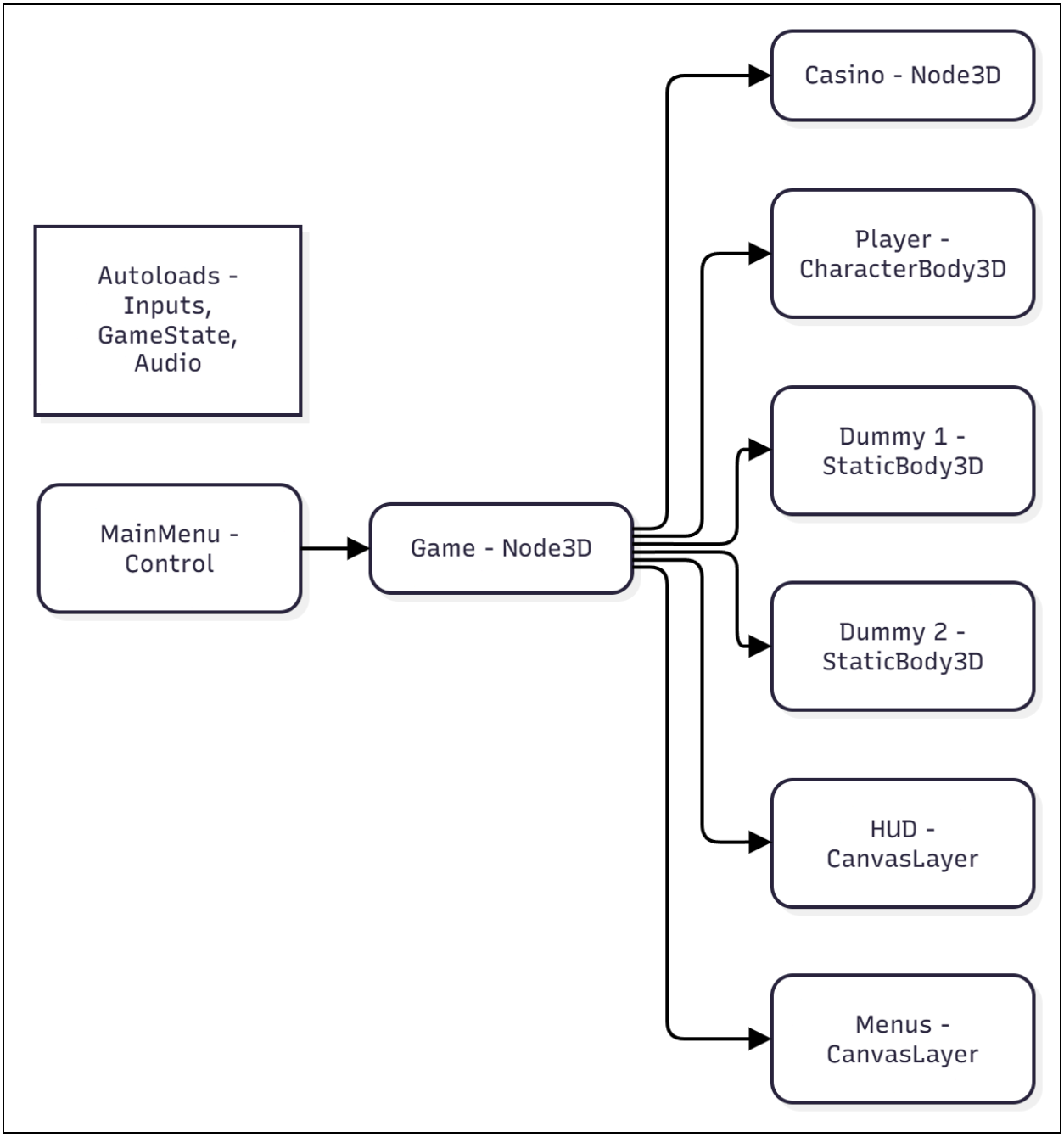
Player action	Primary input	Alternate input	Rationale
Move (move_forward, move_back, move_left, move_right)	W S A D	↑ arrow_key ↓ arrow_key ← arrow_key → arrow_key	Standard first-person layout; alternate supports players used to arrow keys.
Look (look_left, look_right, look_up, look_down)	Mouse movement (Mouse)	I K J L	Mouse is the genre standard; keyboard alternate allows play if the mouse is unavailable.
sit at or leave a table, pick up a stunned teammate (interact)	E	F	One context-sensitive key keeps the control count low.
Hit (hit)	Left mouse button (M1)	Q	Hit is spammable, so it sits on the easiest input.
Push, at a table (push)	Space	Left mouse button	One quick key for the press-your-luck choice.

Player action	Primary input	Alternate input	Rationale
Cash out, at a table (cash_out)	C	Right mouse button	Kept physically apart from Push to reduce accidental cash-outs.
Pause (pause)	Esc	P	Standard; needed for the pause screen the rubric expects.
Raise bet (bet_up)	Mouse wheel up	↑ arrow_key	The wheel is fast and needs no extra key; a seated player cannot move, so the arrow does not conflict.
Lower bet (bet_down)	Mouse wheel down	↓ arrow_key	Mirror of Raise bet.

8.4 Godot Scene Tree Plan


CollisionShape3D
Player -
CharacterBody3D
Head - Node3D
Camera3D
HitArea - Area3D
CollisionShape3D
CollisionShape3D
Dummy -
StaticBody3D
MeshInstance3D


Casino - Node3D
DirectionalLight3D
floor - CSGBox3D
wall1 to wall4 - CSGBox3D
Table - CSGCylinder3D
TableSeat - Area3D
ChickenCross - Node created in code
ExitDoor - CSGBox3D
ExitZone - Area3D
WorldEnvironment created in code
Sign - Label3D created in code



8.5 Signals and Event Wiring

Signal	Emitted by	Connected to	What happens as a result
bet_placed (player_id, table_id, amount)	ChickenCross	GameState	The bet is deducted from the wallet.
bet_resolved (table_id, payout)	ChickenCross	GameState	The payout is added to the wallet; a bust pays 0.
lane_crossed (lane, multiplier)	ChickenCross	TableSeat	HUD message and step sound.
busted(lane)	ChickenCross	TableSeat	Bust message and sound; the bet is lost.
cashed_out (payout)	ChickenCross	TableSeat	Cash-out message and win sound.
player_hit (target)	Player	GameState, Audio	The hit cost of 0.5% of quota leaves the wallet; hit sound.
wallet_changed (balance)	GameState	HUD	Wallet display updates.
day_started (day, quota, open_time)	GameState	HUD, HouseLights, Audio	Day banner, lighting reset, and start sound.
time_changed (time_left)	GameState	HUD	Timer display updates.
quota_status_changed(is_met)	GameState	HUD, ExitDoor	HUD turns green and the door glows green when the wallet is at or above quota.
exit_zone_filled	ExitZone	GameState	If quota is met, the day ends early.

Signal	Emitted by	Connected to	What happens as a result
day_ended(quota_met)	GameState	HUD, Audio, TableSeat	Quota met or missed banner and sound; a seated player stands up.
extra_life_spent	GameState	HUD, HouseLights, Audio	The wallet resets to half of its day-start balance, lighting shifts, and the penalty sound plays.
run_won	GameState	Menus, Audio	Day 10 quota met: win screen and sound.
game_over	GameState	Menus, HouseLights, Audio	Second missed quota: lights cut, game over screen, and sound.